ensure the British were allowed “legitimate” political rights over India on the same grounds as Hindus, all being foreigners.’[21]

The German Sanskritist Dr Max Müller was never an employee of the EICo but for many years Professor of Comparative Philology at Oxford University and directing editor of the monumental fifty-volume *Sacred Books of the East* series published by the Oxford University Press between 1879 and 1910, which included English translations of the Upanishads, the Laws of Manu, the *Bhagavadgita*, the *Institutes of Vishnu*, the *Satapatha Brahmana*, the *Grihya Sutra*s, the *Vedanta Sutra*s, the *Vedic Hymns* and the *Atharva-Veda* – works produced for a world readership and translated for the first time by such lackeys of the British Raj as Georg Bühler, Hermann Oldenberg, Hermann Jacobi, Julius Eggeling, Julius Jolly and George Thibaut. Is Pandit Sharma aware that from August Schlegel – Europe’s first professor of Sanskrit – onwards scores of German scholars have been proud to describe themselves as Indologists and Orientalists?[22] I’m glad to say that many of Max Müller’s works are still in print in India, so perhaps Pandit Sharma is familiar with his lecture ‘What can India teach us?’ in which he championed Indian culture in the following terms:

> If I were asked under what sky the human mind has most fully developed some of its choicest gifts, has most deeply pondered on the greatest problems of life, and has found solutions [for] some of them which well deserve the attention even of those who have studied Plato and Kant – I should point to India. And if I were to ask myself from what literature we, here in Europe, we who have been nurtured almost exclusively on the thoughts of Greeks and Romans, and of one Semitic race, the Jewish, may draw that corrective which is most wanted in order to make our inner life more perfect, more comprehensive, more universal, in fact more truly